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Center on Global Poverty at Johns Hopkins Launches CORE, a Policy Tool to Bridge Research and Action on Global Poverty

BALTIMORE, MD — The Center on Global Poverty at Johns Hopkins University has launched CORE, the Collection of Oriented Research and Evidence for Solving Global Poverty. This new platform is designed to transform how academic research on global poverty and development is accessed and applied by policymakers, practitioners, and researchers.

CORE synthesizes thousands of peer-reviewed studies into concise, plain-language summaries. Each summary highlights what was studied, what was found, and why it matters for policy. Topics are organized by key development themes such as education, health, labor, inequality, and governance. The platform includes smart filters and interactive tools to help users quickly find the most relevant evidence for their questions and contexts.

“There’s more high-quality research on development than ever before, but the real challenge is getting it into the hands of those who can use it,” said Rahardhika Utama, Ph.D, a Northwestern University sociologist who created CORE to translate academic insight into policy action. “CORE offers a practical and scalable way to bridge that gap.”

The idea for CORE was sparked during the 10th Annual Sociology of Development Conference at Johns Hopkins, where participants identified a persistent problem. Although research on poverty and inequality is abundant, much of it is fragmented, locked behind paywalls, or inaccessible to decision-makers who need timely information. CORE was developed in direct response to that challenge.

The platform serves both sides of the research-to-policy equation. Practitioners can access credible evidence to guide programs and interventions, while researchers gain a broader audience for their work. Educators are also integrating CORE into classrooms, where students help expand the database through curated readings and original summaries.

“Most development practitioners lack the time and access to academic databases that they would need to identify relevant research,” said Laura Adams, Ph.D., former USAID staff member and international development consultant. “CORE gives them a way to quickly gain insights into the ways that different policy and structural factors might impact the work that they do.”

“Policymakers often need policy-relevant information fast, to counter or at least factor into their deliberations based on information received from lobbyists in real time,” said Josh Basseches, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Environmental Studies at Tulane University. “The CORE database provides that, bringing peer-reviewed social science right to their fingertips.”

As global development moves toward more equitable and evidence-based approaches, CORE offers a timely and ambitious solution for connecting research to action.

Explore or contribute to the platform at www.coreforsgp.com

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Utama, Rahardhika. 2025. “*CORE (Collection of Oriented Research and Evidence) for Solving Global Poverty.*” Center on Global Poverty at Johns Hopkins University. <https://sites.krieger.jhu.edu/cgp/tools-for-practitioners/>